

**TURKISH
TRADITIONAL**
(ARRANGED BY KIAN RAVAEI)

**GELEVERA
DERESI**

for mezzo-soprano
and piano

ÆI edition

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(2024)

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*Commissioned by Feride Büyükdenktas.
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PROGRAM NOTE

Popularized by singer and activist Kâzım Koyuncu (1971–2005), *Gelevera Deresi* is a well-known folk song from the Black Sea region of Turkey. Like many in Turkey's northern coast, Koyuncu's health deteriorated in the years following the Chernobyl disaster, leading to his premature death from cancer at age 33.

My arrangement—a collaboration with Turkish mezzo-soprano Feride Büyükdenktas—reimagines the tragic love story of *Gelevera Deresi*, but with the Chernobyl disaster as the beloved's cause of death. Amidst melodic shrapnels that evoke the *kemençe*, a Turkish spiked fiddle, the piano intones deep, rumbling chords—a distant explosion. The singer mourns her beloved, who, in the grand scheme of things, is one of many beloveds poisoned by radiation in Chernobyl's wake.

—Kian Ravaei

TEXT & TRANSLATION

Koyverdun gittun beni Allah'undan bulasun
Kimse almasun seni yine bana kalasun

Sevdiğüm senun aşkun ciğerlerumi dağlar
Hiç mi düşünmedun sen sevdiğün boyle ağlar

Gelevera deresi iki dağın arası
Yuzunden silinmesun piçağumun yarası

Sevdiğüm senun aşkun ciğerlerumi dağlar
Hiç mi düşünmedun sen sevdiğün boyle ağlar

You left me and went away, may God curse you!
May no one take you, and may you be mine again.

My beloved, your love breaks my heart.
Didn't you think your beloved would cry like this?

Gelevera Brook is between two mountains.
May my blade scar your face forever.

My beloved, your love breaks my heart.
Didn't you think your beloved would cry like this?

ACKNOWLEDGMENTS

My sincerest thanks to Feride Büyükdenktas and Valerie Coleman, whose guidance was essential in the creation of this work.

duration ca. 5'

to Feride Büyükdenktas

GELEVERA DERESI

Turkish Traditional

Turkish Traditional

Freely, senza misura ♩ = 60

Arranged by Kian Ravaei (2024)

p emotionally withdrawn

Mezzo-Soprano

Koy - ver - dun git - tun be - ni oy koy - ver - dun git - tun be - ni

Piano

pp a distant explosion

2

Al - lah - 'un - dan bu - la - sun oy Al - lah - 'un - dan bu - la - sun

mf pp

3 ♩ = 44, accel. poco a poco.....

precipitando, like black rain

8va

pp cresc......
(con Ped.)

(accel.).....

[3] (8)

mf cresc......

(accel.).....Freely ♩ = 88

[3] (8)

f *sff martellato* *f* *p dolce*

4 Quasi rubato ♩ = 72 *p* heartbroken

Koy - ver - dun git - tun be - ni___ koy - ver - dun git -

8va 5 8va 5 5

pp bring out melody

(sempre con Ped.)

8

-tun be - ni _____ Al - lah - 'un - dan bu - la - sun__

12

Al - lah - 'un - dan bu - la - sun Kim - se al - ma -

poco

p

15

- sun _____ se - ni oy kim - se al - ma - sun _____ se - ni

p

18 *poco*

yi - ne ba - na ka - la - sun Kim - se al - ma - sun _____ se - ni oy

mf pp p

8va

5

22

kim - se al - ma - sun _____ se ni yi - ne ba - na ka - la - sun

8va

pp

5

Red.

26 pushing forward

8va

p espr.

mf

5

a tempo

f with pain

29

Sev - duğum se - nun aş - kun_

f *fagitato*

32

ci - ğer - le - ru -

f 8va

35

- mi dağ - lar_

f

More rubato

pp

37

Hiç mi du - şun me - dun sen

8^{va}

5

3

5

pp

40

Hiç mi du - şun me - dun sen oy

8^{va}

5

5

5

43

sev - duğun boy - le ağ - lar_ sev - duğun boy -

5

46 *poco* *p*

-le ağ - lar Hiç mi du - şun me - dun sen

mf *pp* *p* 5 3

49 *poco*

Hiç mi du - şun me - dun sen oy

pp *p* 8va 5 5 5 *poco*

52 *rit.*

sev - duğun boy - le ağ - lar_ sev - duğun boy - le ağ -

56 ♩ = 44, accel. poco a poco

56

-lar

8va

pp

This system contains measures 56 and 57. Measure 56 begins with a treble clef, a 4/4 time signature, and a single quarter note. Measure 57 is a piano accompaniment consisting of two staves. The right staff features a melodic line with eighth notes and slurs, while the left staff provides a harmonic accompaniment with chords and eighth notes. A dashed line labeled '8va' indicates an octave transposition for the right staff. The dynamic marking 'pp' is placed below the first staff.

(accel.)

57

8va

pp

mf

pp

This system contains measures 57 and 58. Measure 57 continues the piano accompaniment from the previous system. Measure 58 begins with a treble clef, a 4/4 time signature, and a single quarter note. The piano accompaniment continues with two staves. A dashed line labeled '8va' indicates an octave transposition for the right staff. The dynamic marking 'pp' is placed below the first staff, and 'mf' is placed below the second staff.

(accel.)

58

8va

pp

f

pp

This system contains measures 58 and 59. Measure 58 continues the piano accompaniment from the previous system. Measure 59 begins with a treble clef, a 4/4 time signature, and a single quarter note. The piano accompaniment continues with two staves. A dashed line labeled '8va' indicates an octave transposition for the right staff. The dynamic marking 'pp' is placed below the first staff, and 'f' is placed below the second staff.

♩ = 88 rit. Freely ♩ = 60

59

ff *ff* *p* *pp*

Slightly faster, flowing ♩ = 80

61 *mf* with passionate sorrow

Ge - le - ve - ra de - re - si oy Ge - le - ve - ra

mf 5 5 5

65

de - re - si i - ki da - ğun a - ra - si oy

p *mf* 5 5

68 *p* *mf*

i - ki da - ğun a - ra - si Yu - zun - den si -

71

- lin - - me - sun_ yu - zun - den si - lin - - me - sun

74 *fanguished*

pi - ça - ğu - mun ya - ra - si Yu - zun - den si -

8^{va}

77

- lin - - me - sun_ yu - zun - den si - - lin - - me - sun

8va

rit.

Slightly slower, heavier ♩ = 72

ff suffering

80

pi - ça - ğu - mun ya - ra - si Sev - duğum se -

5

ff agitato

83

- nun aş - kun

8va

5

7

86 ***ff***

ci - ğer - le - ru - mi dağ - lar

8va

5

7

rit.

89

5

15ma

5

7

6

8va

p crystalline

Slower, freely ♩ = 66

92 ***p*** holding back tears

Hiç mi du - şun - me - dun sen

(8)

mf

95

Hiç mi du - şun - me - dun sen oy sev - duğun boy -

(8)

p

99

- le ağ - lar_ sev - duğun boy - le ağ - lar_

(8)

mf pp

103

emotionally withdrawn

Hiç mi du - şun - - me - dun sen____

8^{va}

outer voices *p*
inner voice *pp*

mf pp

105

Hiç mi du - şun - - me - dun - sen oy_____

(8)

p *pp*

107

sev - duğun boy - le ağ - lar_____

(8)

pp

109 rit. al fine

sev - duğun boy - le ağ - lar_____

pp

8va

